



PARSING HELP



The HELP facility is *not* intended to provide help with the substance of logic. You can search this document to FIND a particular word or phrase by pressing **Ctrl+F**.

LOGIC NOTE: A discussion, including examples, of how to parse expressions of the various symbolic languages can be found in the TerryText.

Quick Start

Use the Select button to select a problem for parsing from the program's database. The program is also able to check problems created by a User that are not in its database. To enter a User problem click the User button at the bottom of the screen.

The User button invokes a Direct Entry box, which is equipped with the usual facilities for entering symbolic expressions. A right-click in the Direct Entry box will invoke a Toolbox of logical symbols. Just click the symbol you wish to appear. You can also type through the Toolbox while it is open. Pressing Enter is equivalent to clicking the OK button. The standard Ctrl+Shift combinations for typing logical symbols are also available.

Ctrl+Shift+C	$\rightarrow$	(Conditional)
Ctrl+Shift+B	$\leftrightarrow$	(Biconditional)
Ctrl+Shift+A	$\wedge$	(And)
Ctrl+Shift+O	$\vee$	(Or)
Ctrl+Shift+N	$\sim$	(Negation)
Ctrl+Shift+E	$\exists$	(Existential quantifier)
Ctrl+Shift+U	$\forall$	(Universal quantifier)
Ctrl+Shift+I	$\neq$	(Inequality)
Ctrl+Shift+D	ι	(Definite description)
Ctrl+Shift+T	$\therefore$	(Therefore)

When the problem appears in the Problem line in the upper left corner of the screen, select your answer from the three radio buttons that appear below it and Check your work by clicking the Check button or pressing **Ctrl+k**. The result will appear, marked Correct or Incorrect, in the Evaluation field just below the Problem line.

If the expression is well formed, either in Official Notation or in Informal Notation, the evaluator above the Parse field to the right will say "Incomplete" (expressions that are not well-formed are deemed to have their parsing Complete).

Parse the expression by clicking on the main connective to begin building the parse tree. Repeat the process until the parsing is deemed Complete.

Note that atomic formulas containing predicates and variable or Name Letters are regarded as logically complex, and must be parsed to place the terms on a separate node. The same holds for complex terms, which must also be parsed to place their component terms on separate nodes. This is necessary in order to be able to accommodate the logically complex terms that appear in Chapters V and VI.

Atomic formulas of the form predicate-plus-arguments are parsed by clicking on the predicate. Complex terms of the form operation symbol-plus-arguments are parsed by clicking on the operation symbol.

Print your work by clicking the Print button or pressing **Ctrl+p**. The Print window allows you to select as many problems as you wish for printing. Only the problem plus “C” (for Correct) or “I” (for Incorrect or Incomplete) will be printed. Save your work by clicking the Save button or pressing **Ctrl+s**.

Do not fear the Delete button; it delete your work on the problem so you can start over it, but it always first asks you to *confirm* that you wish to delete.

The Menu button brings the opening Menu module to the foreground, allowing you to select a different module or to open another instance of the present module. The Menu module also holds access to the course website, and the Quit button for closing the program. You will be asked if you wish to save your current work before quitting.

The Close button closes the present window. You will be asked if you wish to save your current work before the window is closed.

The Feedback button takes you to a web-based channel for anonymous or open communication with the Instructor, TAs, and authors of the program. It is especially useful for comments or questions about the program, and is a source for the FAQ facility (see below). If you prefer an individual response over anonymity, include your e-mail address with your message.